

The Coca-Cola Company

2Q24 First Impressions

KO just reported 2Q24 Comparable EPS of \$0.84 that compares to Consensus of \$0.81 and Barclays Research \$0.80. The operating beat vs. our model was aided by favorable timing, and we estimate a -1c drag from below the line.

Our Thoughts

As we see it, KO delivered what is needed to support the now, more Consensus bull case, namely continued strong organic sales growth, margin expansion and a gentle raise to top & bottom line for the full year. Organic sales +15% is certainly a headline grabbing figure, and even on an underlying basis (e.g. excluding hyperinflationary pricing and shipment timing) performance was very strong, +6% (the high end of the long term algorithm). We have been particularly focused on KO's ability to generate operating leverage on its top line growth and this quarter again bore that out, with operating margins +120bps (or we'd estimate ~90 bps excluding shipment timing). Regarding the raise to the full year outlook, our understanding is this just reflects progress year-to-date and a steady state external environment – aka there is no assumption for a change/improvement in consumer spending trends or the macro backdrop across markets. Also worth mentioning in this context is that the FX headwind to bottom line is a bit larger than previously anticipated, such that the FXN EPS growth moves up by ~2 points.

Highlights

- Organic sales +15% vs. our +9%, and concentrate (not price/mix) drove the majority of the beat but included a 4-point timing benefit
- EMEA, LatAm, North America and BIG each outperformed our expectations by mid-single to low-double digit rates
- Unit case volumes +2% vs. our +1.5%
- Gross margins +200 bps vs. our +130 bps, with strong reinvestment (absolute SG&A ~6.8% higher than our forecast) translating to +120 bps of operating margin expansion (vs. our 75 bps)

Lowlights

- North America UCV -1% vs. our +0.5%, with most categories in decline (ex. juice, value-added dairy and plant-based)

2024 Guidance

- Updated:
 - Organic revenue +9-10% (from +8-9% & vs. us & Consensus at +9.1%)
 - FX headwind of 5-6% on net revenues (from 4-5% & vs. our -4.9% and Consensus -5.0%) & 8-9% drag on comparable EPS (from 7-8%)
 - Structural headwind of ~4-5% on net revenues (unchanged) and a 1-2% (from ~2%) drag on comparable EPS

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| CORE

KO	OVERWEIGHT
U.S. CHPC & Beverages	NEUTRAL
Price Target	USD 69.00
Price (22-Jul-24)	USD 64.77
Potential Upside/Downside	+6.5%

U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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BCI, US

- Comparable constant currency EPS +13-15% (from +11-13%)
- Comparable EPS +5-6% that implies \$2.82-\$2.85 (from +4-5% vs. our and Consensus \$2.82)
- Maintained:
 - Effective tax rate 19.0%, not including impact of ongoing tax litigation
 - All cash flow & capex metrics

3Q24 Guidance

- Net revenue headwinds: FX ~4% (our -4.3%); structural ~4-5% (our -5%)
- Comparable EPS headwinds: FX ~8%; structural ~1-2%

KO 2Q24 Earnings Call Details:

Today @ 8:30 AM ET - U.S. Dial: 1-888-415-4465; International: 1-646-960-0140; Passcode: 6819315.

Analyst(s) Certification(s):

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Primary Stocks (Ticker, Date, Price)

The Coca-Cola Company (KO, 22-Jul-2024, USD 64.77), Overweight/Neutral, A/CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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Constellation Brands (STZ)	Coty Inc. (COTY)	Duckhorn Portfolio Inc (NAPA)
Edgewell Personal Care Company (EPC)	Energizer Holdings, Inc (ENR)	International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF)
Keurig Dr Pepper (KDP)	Kimberly-Clark Corp. (KMB)	Molson Coors Beverage Company (TAP)

Newell Brands Inc. (NWL)	ODDITY Tech Ltd. (ODD)	Olaplex Holdings, Inc. (OLPX)
PepsiCo Inc. (PEP)	Procter & Gamble (PG)	Reynolds Consumer Products (REYN)
The Coca-Cola Company (KO)	The Estée Lauder Companies (EL)	

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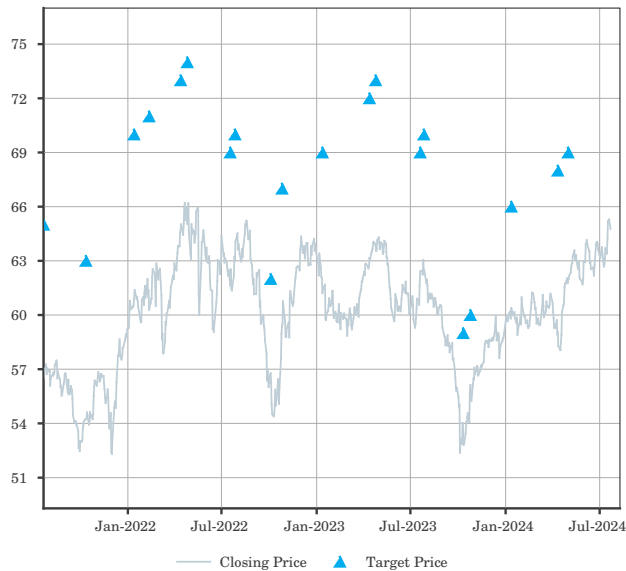
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 64.77** (22-Jul-2024)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 22-Jul-2024)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
01-May-2024	61.77		69.00
11-Apr-2024	59.72		68.00
12-Jan-2024	59.81		66.00
25-Oct-2023	55.64		60.00
11-Oct-2023	54.03		59.00
27-Jul-2023	63.05		70.00
20-Jul-2023	61.64		69.00
25-Apr-2023	63.95		73.00
13-Apr-2023	62.69		72.00
12-Jan-2023	61.21		69.00
26-Oct-2022	58.95		67.00
04-Oct-2022	56.78		62.00
27-Jul-2022	63.21		70.00
18-Jul-2022	61.65		69.00
26-Apr-2022	65.94		74.00
13-Apr-2022	64.73		73.00
11-Feb-2022	61.38		71.00
13-Jan-2022	60.90		70.00
12-Oct-2021	54.23		63.00

On 23-Jul-2021, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 65.00.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: 1) FX headwinds force downward revision of estimates, 2) Slowdown in CSD category growth, 3) More sugar taxes cloud the dialogue, 4) Deterioration in North American pricing environment would hurt results

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